WHO IS KPUD?

A community-owned public utility serving Kitsap County residents, businesses, and visitors.



CREATED BY VOTERS

Kitsap Public Utility District (KPUD) was initially established by Kitsap County voters in 1940 with the authority to provide electric service to the community.

Shortly after KPUD was formed, World War II shifted local priorities. KPUD first began providing drinking water, and over the next eight decades, its services expanded to include wholesale fiber internet and wastewater, evolving to meet the changing needs of Kitsap County.

ABOUT KPUD

Kitsap Public Utility District is a municipal corporation and a special purpose district in Washington state, governed by three locally elected commissioners.

Board meetings are open to the public under Washington's Open Public Meetings Act, and KPUD is subject to the state Public Records Act and audits by the Washington State Auditor's Office.

KPUD reflects the development of the public utility district model, which is built on communities establishing and governing public utilities to meet local needs.

A STRONG PUBLIC NETWORK

Through its membership and leadership in the Washington Public Utility Districts Association, KPUD works alongside public utility districts and utility professionals across Washington and the region with experience providing drinking water, wastewater, fiber internet, and electric utility services.

KPUD'S UTILITY SERVICES TODAY

DRINKING WATER

KPUD owns and operates drinking water systems throughout Kitsap County, providing clean, reliable water to more than 35,000 customers.

FIBER INTERNET INFRASTRUCTURE

KPUD operates a publicly owned open access fiber network with more than 1,050 miles of fiber infrastructure. Customers choose from several internet service providers who use the network to deliver services.

WASTEWATER

KPUD provides wastewater treatment services in Port Gamble and Bainbridge Island, operating facilities that safeguard public health and the environment, including Puget Sound.

WATER RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

KPUD manages Kitsap County's unique water resources through monitoring rainfall, streamflow, and aquifers. This work supports healthy waterways and protects fish habitat.

08.2026

LOCAL GOVERNANCE. PUBLIC ACCOUNTABILITY.

The KPUD Board of Commissioners sets policy, approves rates and budgets, and oversees KPUD operations. Board meetings are public, and KPUD is accountable to the communities it serves.

ESTABLISHED
1940
by Kitsap County voters

GOVERNANCE
3-MEMBER
elected Board of Commissioners

EMPLOYEES
NEARLY 100
professionals serving the community

FIBER NETWORK
1,000+
miles of fiber infrastructure

WATER CUSTOMERS
35,000+
customers served

UNDERSTANDING THE BALLOT MEASURE

On the November 4, 2026, General Election ballot, Kitsap County voters will be asked whether Kitsap Public Utility District (KPUD) should be granted legal authority to construct or acquire electric facilities to generate, transmit or distribute electric power. The ballot language is defined by state law in RCW 54.08.070. The measure will appear on the ballot as KPUD Proposition 1.

WHY IS THIS MEASURE ON THE BALLOT?

KPUD began considering its potential role in electric service in response to community interest. Under state law, KPUD must receive approval from voters in the district before it can acquire or construct electric facilities.

This measure, KPUD Proposition 1, asks voters to provide KPUD with legal authority to acquire or construct electric utilities. However, approval would not require KPUD to provide electric service. If approved, the Board of Commissioners has committed to conducting a feasibility study to evaluate whether providing electric service would benefit the community before taking any action to exercise that authority.

WHAT DOES YOUR VOTE DECIDE?

Your vote would decide whether KPUD receives legal authority to acquire or construct electric facilities.

This measure does not:

- Change who provides electric service today.
- Determine electric rates.
- Transfer ownership of existing electric facilities.
- Approve financing or issuance of bonds.
- Require KPUD to acquire an electric system.
- Require KPUD to provide electric service.
- Establish a timeline for future action.

Decisions about electric service, including the provider, ownership of existing facilities, rates, financing, and any future action, would be separate matters.

WHAT DOES A "YES" VOTE DO?

A “Yes” vote gives KPUD authority to provide electric service but does not require KPUD to do so. The KPUD Board of Commissioners has directed that a feasibility study be completed before taking any action to pursue electric service. Any future decision to pursue electric service would be made by the Board during a public meeting through the existing public process.

WHAT DOES A "NO" VOTE DO?

A “No” vote means KPUD would not receive authority to construct or acquire electric facilities, and the feasibility study would not move forward. The process would stop at this point, and any future action would require a new process.



QUESTIONS WE ARE HEARING: PART I

Kitsap community members have asked questions about why the measure is on the ballot, what a “yes” or “no” vote would mean, and what could happen next. The following questions address some of the most common topics KPUD is hearing and provides factual information about the ballot measure and the process that would follow.

HOW WOULD KPUD GOVERNANCE DIFFER FROM THE CURRENT ELECTRIC PROVIDER?

KPUD is a public municipal corporation governed by locally elected commissioners. Board meetings are open to the public, and KPUD is subject to Washington's public records and public meetings laws. The current electric provider is an investor-owned utility regulated by the Washington Utilities and Transportation Commission.

WHY IS KPUD ASKING VOTERS FOR AUTHORITY TO ACQUIRE OR CONSTRUCT ELECTRIC FACILITIES BEFORE CONDUCTING A FEASIBILITY STUDY?

Community members have asked KPUD to consider whether it could help address electric service costs and other concerns. A comprehensive feasibility study is estimated to cost between $300,000 and $500,000.

Voters in other Washington communities have considered similar measures. Of four electric authority measures presented to voters in 2008 and 2012, one was approved and three were not. Given the significant cost of a comprehensive feasibility study and voting history for similar measures, the Board determined that it was prudent to seek voter direction first.

WHAT WOULD THE FEASIBILITY STUDY TELL US?

A feasibility study would provide information the Board would need to evaluate whether pursuing electric service is in the best interest of Kitsap County residents. Areas of analysis could include infrastructure and engineering requirements, power supply, costs and financing, rates and revenue, staffing and operations, legal and regulatory requirements, and other factors.

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER THE FEASIBILITY STUDY?

The results of the feasibility study would be presented to the KPUD Board of Commissioners for review and consideration. The process would be conducted publicly, and the information gathered during the investigative period would help inform the Board’s consideration of any future action. No further action would be taken until the Board has reviewed the information.

WOULD PROPERTY TAXES OR ELECTRIC RATES CHANGE IF PROPOSITION 1 PASSES?

No, Proposition 1 would not immediately change property taxes or electric rates.

KPUD currently levies a property tax of approximately $0.045 per $1,000 of assessed property value, or about $22.50 per year on a $500,000 home.

Under state law, regular property-tax revenue generally may increase by no more than 1% each year, plus amounts resulting from new construction and other permitted adjustments. An increase beyond the regular levy limit, known as a levy lid lift, requires voter approval. Proposition 1 does not authorize a property-tax increase or constitute a levy lid lift.

DOES KPUD HAVE EXPERIENCE PROVIDING ELECTRIC SERVICE?

No, KPUD does not currently provide electric service. However, KPUD operates public utility services and infrastructure and participates in state and regional public power organizations. These organizations include utilities with extensive experience providing electric service. Of Washington’s 28 PUDs, 24 provide electric service. A feasibility study would evaluate how KPUD could draw on available expertise, partnerships, resources, and the infrastructure, power supply, costs and other requirements associated with electric service.

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QUESTIONS WE ARE HEARING: PART II

HOW LONG WOULD IT TAKE KPUD TO BEGIN PROVIDING ELECTRIC SERVICE?

There is no timeline for beginning electric service at this time. If voters approve Proposition 1, KPUD would first conduct a comprehensive feasibility study. The time required to establish electric service would depend on the findings of that study and subsequent decisions by the Board. For context, PUDs that have established electric service have typically required several years to begin operations. Jefferson Public Utility District, the most recent Washington PUD to begin providing electric service, took approximately five years.

WHERE WOULD KPUD GET ITS POWER?

No power source has been selected. A feasibility study would evaluate potential power supply options, including available sources and associated costs.

Bonneville Power Administration (BPA) currently transmits power to Kitsap County and works with public power utilities across Washington. Under federal law, BPA has an obligation to supply power to public utilities that request it, subject to applicable requirements and available resources. BPA is one potential resource that could be evaluated as part of a future feasibility study, but no decision has been made about where KPUD would purchase or obtain power.

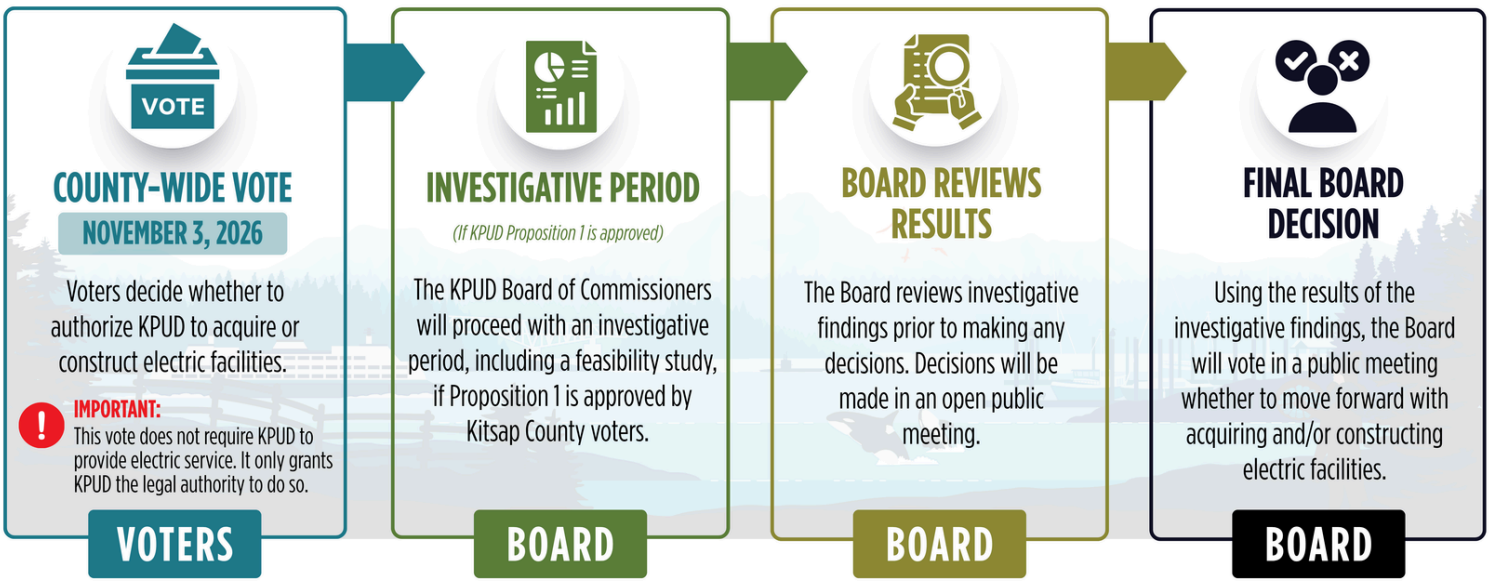
WHAT IF THE CURRENT ELECTRIC PROVIDER DOES NOT WANT TO SELL ITS SYSTEM?

If KPUD Proposition 1 passes, the feasibility study results are favorable, and the current electric provider is not interested in selling its system, KPUD could consider pursuing a court process to acquire the system.

Washington law (RCW 54.16.020) gives public utility districts authority to acquire electric facilities through negotiated purchase or, when necessary, through a legal process overseen by the courts. Any acquisition would be subject to the requirements of state law, including a determination of the property's fair value.

If voters approve the measure, KPUD would first need to complete a feasibility study and determine whether acquiring or constructing electric facilities is financially and operationally in the best interest of Kitsap County residents. No decision has been made to acquire the current provider's system.

UNDERSTANDING THE DECISION PROCESS:



THE PROCESS MAY STOP AT ANY POINT. The process pauses or ends if the public vote is not approved, OR the Board votes not to proceed.

September 2026